

Abu Dhabi and Dubai- All Inclusive Travel Guide

Bon Voyage by Marina

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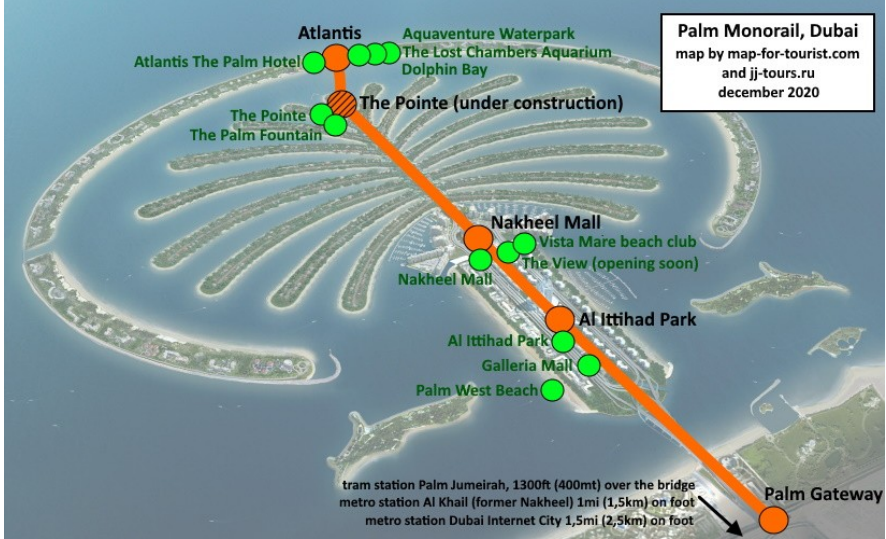
Dec 15, Sunday	● Arrive in Abu Dhabi at 6:30 am ○ transfer to hotel- Holiday Inn Abu Dhabi (20 min drive from the airport). Spend the day sightseeing in Abu Dhabi: ● Visit the Grand Mosque Admission is free ○ Open from 9 am - 10 pm ○ People generally spend 2-3 hrs here ● Cover knees and shoulders and women need to cover their heads with a scarf. ● Then visit the Louvre Abu Dhabi ○ Open 10 am - 8:30 pm. Closed on Mondays ○ Plan to arrive here by 10 am. ○ People generally spend 3-4 hours here. ○ Book the admission tickets online. It is AED 60 for adults and
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	is free for those under 18. ○ An Admission Ticket gives you access to the museum galleries, exhibitions, outdoor plazas underneath the dome, museum café, Fouquet's Abu Dhabi and boutique. ○ Must see at Louvre Abu Dhabi: Link 1 and Link 2 ● Lunch Options: ○ There are a bunch of sea facing restaurants around 2 kms from the museum. Our Picks (all have good vegetarian options) ■ Antonia - Mamsha Al Saadiyat - Italian (Burrata pizza, seafood pasta, truffle pasta, gelato) ■ NIRI Restaurant and Bar - Japanese (corn tempura, soft shell crab) ■ Pickl Mamsha Al Saadiyat - Burgers and Fries ■ Beirut Sur Mer Restaurant - Lebanese (mixed grill, kunafa, shisha) ○ There are also a bunch of restaurants including a couple of South Indian ones on the way to the grand mosque at about 5 mins from the museum. ■ San Thai Diner Restaurant (mango sticky rice, papaya salad, laksa) ■ Prego's Restaurant - Italian (mushroom risotto, seafood risotto, lasagna) ■ TELUGU RUCHI RESTAURANT (veg thali, chicken biryani) ■ Kahani Restaurant - Kerala (thalis- veg and non veg) ● After that, visit the Qasr Al Watan (25 mins from the Grand Mosque), the Palace of the Nation for the light and sound show ○ You can book tickets here- it is recommended to book through the official site only. ○ The show is an immersive light and sound display set against the backdrop of the Abu Dhabi night sky. It lasts about 15 minutes. ○ The timing for the show is at 6:45pm. Last entry for the show is at 6:15 pm ○ Dress code: As a courtesy to other guests and in accordance with local laws and customs, all visitors are requested to wear respectful clothing while in the Palace. We recommend that both knees and shoulders be covered. ● After that, you can visit the Emirates Palace (5 mins from the Qasr Al Watan) - Overlooking its own marina and 1.3 kilometres of pristine
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	private beach, the Emirates Palace Abu Dhabi is an architectural icon. It has 114 gold domes and 1,002 chandeliers to its high arches, towering ceilings and long hallways decorated with gold inlays and metallic and glass mosaics. ○ It is free to visit and you can also access 11 of its restaurants and bars. ○ You can choose to dine here or around. Here are our picks ■ Vendôme ● A vibrant all-day dining restaurant offering multi-national cuisine. ● Cost: Approx. AED 300-400 per person for a buffet ■ Lebanese Terrace ● A menu inspired by Lebanon's coastal cuisine (mixed grill platter, potato hara, halloumi) ● Cost: Approx. AED 150-200 per person ■ Martabaan by Hemant Oberoi ● Contemporary Classic Indian dining ● Cost: 4 course set menu at AED 300 per person ● Ala carte options available ■ Moksh Indian Restaurant ● Cost: Approx AED 100 per person ■ Horizon ● International Cuisine with Oriental Flavours ● Limited menu including burgers, pastas and grilled seafood ● Cost: Approx. AED 100-150 per person ■ Kamoon ● Middle Eastern Restaurant (fattoush, tabbouleh, lentil soup, hummus beirut, shish taouk) ● Cost: Approx. AED 50-100 per person ■ Sunset Life Restaurant and Cafe ● Pizza, Pasta, Sandwich, Quesadilla ● Cost: Approx. AED 50 per person ● <i>Optional activity</i> - view the Grand Mosque lit up at night Spend the night in Abu Dhabi.
Dec 16, Monday	● Spend the day at SeaWorld Abu Dhabi (30 min drive from the hotel) ○ Buy the single park ticket for Seaworld (AED 375 per person) ● Then travel to Dubai and check into your Dubai hotel- Millennium Al Barsha. (1-1.5 hr drive)

	● If you have time in the evening, you can take a taxi to Jumeirah beach (20 mins from the hotel), walk along the Jumeirah Beach Walking Board and spend time at the beach. You can have dinner at one of the places off Sheikh Zayed Road mentioned in your eating guide below, or around your hotel.
Dec 17, Tuesday	● Go skydiving in the morning! Slot already booked at 10 am. ○ The location is about 20 mins from the hotel ○ Be there at 10 am. Expect to spend 3-4 hours here. ● Head to the Pointe at the Palm for lunch with a view. ○ Take a taxi from your sky diving drop off point ○ Spend time browsing the shops ● Embark on a private sunset yacht cruise ○ Reach the Royal Blue coast Yacht Rental at Dubai Marina walk by 4:45 pm ○ Location: Dubai Marina Walk, Near Spinneys, Round About, In front of Gate T ○ It is a 17 min taxi drive from the Pointe. ○ The cruise is from 5-7pm ● Then visit the traditional souks (markets) in Dubai for some shopping.
Dec 18, Wednesday	● Spend the late morning/early afternoon at the Dubai Mall, (15 min taxi drive from the hotel). It is one of the largest malls in the world. Use travelators and escalators to avoid walking much. ○ Spend time at a skating rink or at some of the Christmas activities. ○ Explore the many shops and have lunch at any of the restaurants around. ● Then, Ascend to the observation decks for panoramic views of the city from the tallest building in the world- the Burj Khalifa (4 min walk from the mall) ○ Book tickets in advance- Standard Tickets: Level 124 & 125 or VIP level 148 ○ Plan to be here by 4:00- 4:30pm ● Once you are back downstairs, you can all enjoy the Dubai Fountain Show at the foot of Burj Khalifa, with music and choreographed water jets. The show takes place every 30 mins from 6pm onwards and is free. ● Have dinner around (at Dubai Mall) and head back to your hotel.
Dec 19, Thursday	● Ski Dubai Snow Park in Mall of Emirates (3 min taxi drive or hotel may have a shuttle). ○ It is open from 10 am - 11pm. Sat and sun it is open from 9 am-12 am ○ average time spent is 3-4 hours ○ Two ticket options: AED 440 or AED 520 for two. The more

	expensive option includes One-time access to the chairlift and Mountain Thriller ride ○ Ski Dubai also has a Winter Wonderland experience from Dec 1- 25th. Enjoy a snowy Christmas in Dubai, complete with a meet-and-greet with Santa, a photo, and a hot chocolate for Dhs160. Families of four can grab a discounted package for Dhs600, and there's an upgrade option for Dhs325 to enjoy the snow park and chairlift. ● The desert landscape safari begins at 2:30 pm. They will pick you up at 1:45 pm. ○ You will be taken in a private 4x4 vehicle. Includes dune bashing, BBQ dinner, camel rides, sandboarding, sunset views, and all desert camp activities. ○ You can book this experience online ○ You can choose your pickup point- either from Mall of Emirates or the hotel
Dec 20, Friday	● Visit the Dubai Miracle garden- (15 mins drive from the hotel). It is the world's largest flower garden ○ Average time that visitors spend is about 3 hours. ○ Prices are 95 AED per adult, 80 AED for upto 11 year olds. ○ If you like, you can look to visit the Dubai Butterfly garden, which is next to the Miracle Garden and has more than 15,000 butterflies. ○ Both gardens offer tram services so walking time can be reduced. ○ Tickets for Miracle Garden ○ Tickets for Butterfly Garden ● These tickets can also be booked on the same day or even onsite. Spend the evening at the Palm Jumeirah , an artificial archipelago with luxurious hotels and resorts ● Take a monorail ride for an elevated view of the island. ● You can book these tickets on the same day. ● We recommend buying the Day Pass With Unlimited Rides For AED 35 (see the monorail map below) ● The final stop for the monorail is at Atlantis the Palm hotel, a must visit place when in Dubai. We recommend starting your trip to the Palm, there. (People typically spend 60-90 mins here) ● The Nakheel mall station gives access to The Palm Tower, The View at the Palm, St. Regis Dubai, and Club Vista Mare. The View is another must visit. ● The Al Ittihad station connects directly to the Golden Mile Galleria, where visitors can shop to their hearts' content. It also connects to Palm West Beach, an ideal place to swim, eat, and relax by the sea.

	
Dec 21, Saturday	● In the morning, visit the Museum of the Future (15 min taxi drive). Tickets booked for 11am ● Afterwards, you can visit the Dubai Festival City Mall (10 min taxi drive) which is the biggest entertainment, dining & fashion mall in Dubai and will have many of its stores participating in the Dubai Shopping Festival. ○ Dubai Festival City's Wishful Winter Wonderland offers a magical holiday experience starting 7th December. The Christmas tree lighting and IMAGINE show will kick off the season, along with festive kiosks, character meet-and-greets, and Santa's log cabin for kids. Highlights include Magical Workshops, the Ice Maze, and a Holiday Extravaganza with performances and a parade ● In the evening, explore the Global Village (20 min taxi drive), a massive cultural theme park featuring pavilions from over 150 countries, showcasing their food, crafts, and entertainment. It opens at 4pm, and is a well-known family-friendly location. ○ Prices begin at INR 700. ○ You can book tickets online but you can also do so on the same day or even onsite. ○ The theme park is decorated even better with lights and carousels, bringing Christmas traditions from across the world under one roof. You can take pictures under the giant Christmas Tree, visit the Mini Festive Market for a Christmas Market experience and eat Christmas treats from around the world.
Dec 22, Sunday	● Spend the day at IMG Worlds of Adventure: Lost Valley - Dinosaur Adventure ○ It is a 20 min taxi ride away from the hotel. ○ General admission is AED 365 per person. Tickets can be

	bought online in advance • Spend the evening shopping. You can either visit Meena Bazaar for electronics or re-visit Mall of Emirates, Dubai Mall or Dubai Festival City Mall to get all your items ticked off your shopping list! • Alternatively, you can decide to visit Dubai Outlet Mall for clothes shopping
Dec 23, Monday	Relax in the morning at the hotel, after check out, have lunch and travel to the airport. Fly back to India with memories of a lifetime!

Important Places Around Your Hotels

Convenience stores

- Abu Dhabi:
 - [Abu Dhabi Co-operative Society](#) - Muroor Branch Hypermarket
 - 700 meters from the hotel
 - Open 24 hrs
- Dubai:
 - [Happy Sky Grocery](#)
 - 400 meters from the hotel
 - Open from 7 am – 3:30 am

Hospital

- Abu Dhabi:
 - [Cleveland Clinic](#) Abu Dhabi
 - 13 km - 25 mins from the hotel
 - Open 24 hrs
- Dubai
 - [Dubai London Clinic](#) and Speciality Hospital
 - 8.5 km - 20 mins from the hotel
 - Open 24 hrs

Pharmacy

- Abu Dhabi
 - [LIFE PHARMACY](#) - AUH 99, MUROOR COMPLEX
 - 700 meters from the hotel
 - Open from 10 am - 12:30 am
 - [Medicina Pharmacy](#) - International
 - 1 km from the hotel
 - Open 24 hrs
- Dubai:
 - [LIFE Pharmacy](#) - EXTRA Life
 - 2 mins walk from the hotel
 - Open 24 hrs

Important Numbers in Dubai

Here are few numbers you may need while in Dubai

- 999- Police
- 997- Fire
- 998- Ambulance
- 995- Find and rescue
- [Consulate General of India](#): +971 4 397 1333

Recommended things to buy/carry

- Travel Insurance-. Recommendation- TATA AIG
- The weather in Dubai during December is expected to be pleasant with a minimum of 17 degrees and a maximum of 26 degrees. Carry a light sweater specially for the evenings. But it is still recommended to carry summer caps, sunscreen and pack light cotton clothes during the day. Do also ensure that you carry water with you whenever you are stepping out.
- Travel adaptors- Type C, D and G plug adaptor for UAE
- Doctors prescriptions/travel prescriptions for medicines (except over the counter meds)
- Walking shoes!
- Portable chargers (as you will be on the move for most of the time)
- Forex (cash and cards)- our recommendation is the BookMyForex card. Many of our clients have also used the Niyo travel card and have had a good experience.

Common Phrases in Dubai

Arabic Word	Meaning in English
Marhaba	Hello
Kaif Halak?	How are you?
Shukran	Thank you
Na'am	Yes
la	No
Maasalaamah	Goodbye

Recommended Apps

- Google Translate
- Google Maps

Regarding Foreign Currency

- AED also *known as the United Arab Emirates dirham* or simply as the Emirati dirham, is the currency of the United Arab Emirates.
- 1 Dirham is ~23 INR
- While most establishments like restaurants and shops accept cards, you will need cash for small shops and in the souk, as well as street food vendors.
- Exchange money before going and carry forex cash and cards. If you need some additional cash while there, the most cost effective way is to use an ATM. Do check with your banks regarding the charges.
- Ensure that the cards you are carrying are activated for international spends.

Mobile Connectivity while in Dubai

- Etisalat and Du are both widely used networks.
- Prepaid SIM cards in the UAE are sometimes available for free, but mostly they are available with the package for AED 50-100 (depending on the plan you select). They can be picked at the airport.
- The packages of these two companies are also slightly different, but DU's packages are slightly cheaper than Etisalat's.
- Etisalat's 4G coverage is very good and is available in every city and region.
- DU's 5G coverage is better than Etisalat's, but its 5G speed is slightly slower than Etisalat's.
- Most people in Dubai use the Du sim cards.

Getting Around in Dubai

Public Transport

- Please bear in mind that it is not possible to pay in cash for any means of public transport in Dubai.
- The NOL card (Nol Card) is a rechargeable card that allows all public transport in the city to be used in an easy way
- It can be purchased at any metro station.
- There are different types of Nol cards. The Silver card is recommended for tourists. It costs 25 AED which includes a 19 AED credit.
- Download the RTA Dubai app, for information on schedules and prices and also to recharge the Nol card.
- The Nol card can also be recharged at any of the designated recharge machines available at metro and bus stations.

Other pointers to consider:

- Each passenger needs 1 Nol card
- The minimum card balance is 7.5 AED
- The maximum balance value is 1,000 AED for Anonymous nol cards and 5,000 AED for Personal and registered cards
- In order to activate the pending top up, please use your card in any online parking meter, metro gates, nol pay application or Solar Top-up Machines after 45 minutes to 4 hours to update your card balance.
- It is important to remember to swipe the card at the end of your journey, otherwise, you will be charged the maximum fare instead of paying the correct fare.
- The lowest fare is for short journeys of up to 1.8 miles, which allows you 1 transfer of up to 90 minutes. For this option, the price is 3 AED (US\$ 0.80) for silver cards
- You can also use your nol card to pay at certain stores- please refer to this link- <https://www.rta.ae/wps/portal/rta/ae/public-transport/nol/nol-merchants>

Cabs

- You can hail down taxis belonging to the Dubai Taxi Corporation. – these are red topped cars.
- The meter starts at Dhs5 from 6am-10pm, and Dhs5.5 from 10pm-6am and Dhs2.19 per km
- You can also pre book these taxis using the DTC mobile app

Other ride hailing apps

- Careem- which offers the Hala taxi, which are generally affordable rides- Dhs8 starting fee, Dhs12 minimum fare, and Dhs1.91 per km.
- Uber- generally more expensive but since it offers a flat rate, it could work out more affordable during peak hours and for longer distances.

Getting Around in Abu Dhabi

Cabs

- You can hire a taxi for the day (10 hrs)

Ride hailing apps

- Uber- generally more expensive but since it offers a flat rate, it could work out more affordable during peak hours and for longer distances.

Restaurant options in Dubai

Name of restaurant	Cuisine	Speciality	Ambience	Location	Price per person
Chalet Grill Plus	Multicuisine including Indian	Mixed grill, grilled chicken, hummus and muttabal	Casual	3 mins walk from the hotel	AED 50 - 100
Sri Krishna Bhavan Vegetarian Restaurant	South Indian	Dosas	Casual	900 meters from the hotel	AED 1 - 50
Dip Dash Restaurant & Café	Pan Asian - Vegetarian	Dimsums, khaosuey, veg sushi, mango sushi	Casual	1 km from the hotel	AED 50 - 100
Bikanerwala	Indian	Breakfast, Quick lunch and dinner Sweet options	Casual	Sheikh Zayed Road	Reasonably priced AED 1-50 per person Open 8am-12 am.
Bombay Chowpatty	Indian street food	Pav Bhaji, Chole Bature, Dosa	Casual	Multiple locations Sheikh Zayed road	Open 8 am-1130 pm AED 1-50 per person

				Mall of Emirates, Dubai Mall	
SpiceKlub	Indian	Vegetarian	Indoor dining	Al Mankhool, Option for when you visit the souks	Modern presentation Open 12-3:30pm 6:30-11:30 pm AED 50-100 per person
Leila	Lebanese	Serves veg and vegan dishes also. Mezze plates, salads, pizzas	Terrace available	Downtown Dubai	10am- 12:45 am
Zaroob	Arabic	Serves veg and vegan dishes also- Mezze plates, salads, pizzas	Live cooking stations on 2 floors recreating Arabic street fare with a twist, in a market setting. Has outdoor seating	Jumeriah Tower Building, Sheik Zayed Road,	AED 50-100 per person
Taquado Mexican Kitchen	Mexican	Veg options, fajitas, burriots and tacos and burgers	Indoor seating	Mall of Emirates	AED 1-50 per person Open 10am-10 pm
Aroos Damascus	Syrian	Serves veg and vegan also-. Mezze plates, salads, mains like moussaka	Has outdoor seating	Sheik Zayed Road	AED 50-100 per person Open 11am- 4 pm

Carluccio	Italian	Pastas and pizzas, handmade foccacia	Casual setting has outdoor seating	Dubai Mall	Popular Italian chain AED 50-150 per person Open 9am- 12 am
L'eto Dubai	Bakery and cake shop	Pistachio cake, macarons, milk cake	Casual setting	Dubai Mall	Open 9am-12am
TimeOut Market Dubai	Food hall	Baos, pizzas, Phos	casual setting	Near dubai Mall and fountain	Open 12pm-12am
Parkers	French	Matilda Cake, fries, burgers	Casual setting	Dubai Mall	AED 50-150 per item open 9am-11:30ppm
Chocomelt	Chocolate Cafe	Baby Dynamite, Popcorn mountain banana pudding, biscoff crepe	Casual Setting	Dubai Mall	AED 50-100 per item open 10:00 am-12am
Public	Multicuisine (mostly Italian)	Has veg options, Curly corn, pizzas, tiramisu, crazy truffle pasta, parmesan fries,	Casual setting, has outdoor seating too	Dubai Mall	Open 9am-1am
Bosporous Turkish Cuisine	Turkish	Has veg options, mezze platters, cheese rolls, turkish tea	Casual setting, has outdoor seating too	Dubai Mall	Open 8am-12:30am
Hafiz Mustafa 1864	Turkish sweets	Baklava, turkish delights, turkish coffee	Casual setting, has outdoor seating too	Dubai Mall	AED 50-150 per item Open 8am-12:00am

Flaky Pastry Dubai	Bakery and Cake shop	Croissants, cinnamon rolls, coffee, crookie, vanilla flan		City Walk II	AED 50-100 per item open 7:30am-10pm
Fi'lia Dubai	Italian	Has veg dishes. Truffle izza, pavlova, cacio e pepe pasta, tiramisu	Beautiful terrace setting	SLS Dubai Hotels and Residences, Dubai Business Bay.	Open 12:30-3:30 pm 6:30pm-12am Located on the 70th floor Reservations required sevenrooms.com
Bombay Bungalow	Mumbai Street Food	Samosas, pav bhaji	Has outdoor seating	The Beach Mall, JBR Walk	AED 50-150 per person Open 10 am-12 pm
Berenjack Dubai	Persian	Saffron rice, iranian bread, = eggplant, hummus, baklava		Jumeirah	Open 12-5pm 6-11:30pm
Milk Bakery	Bakery and cake shop	Breakfast/brunch, Turkish eggs, Avocado toast, Pastries, milk chocolate cookie, coffee	Casual Seating	Jumeirah	AED 50-100 per item open 7:30am-12am Sat-sun open from 8am
Bluebarjeel restaurant	Arabic	Shawarmas, kubz, Turkish coffee	Seating by the creek	Option for when you visit the Souks	AED 1-100 per dish

Maraheb Restaurant	Yemini	Mandi, Hanith	Indoor seating	Off sheik Zayed road 18 mins by metro	AED 50-100 per dish 11am-11:30pm
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Famous Vegetarian Local Dishes

- **Fattoush:** This vibrant salad is a refreshing and healthy option. It's made with toasted or fried pita bread pieces tossed with chopped vegetables, herbs, and a tangy lemon dressing.
- **Balaleet:** This sweet vermicelli dish is traditionally served for breakfast but can be enjoyed at any time of day. It's made with fried vermicelli noodles, cardamom, saffron, rosewater, and topped with fried nuts and raisins.
- **Mutabbal:** This creamy eggplant dip is a popular mezze dish. It's made with roasted eggplant, tahini, lemon juice, olive oil, and garlic.
- **Moussaka:** This layered eggplant dish is a vegetarian take on the classic Greek dish. It's made with layers of fried eggplant, tomatoes, onions, and a creamy bechamel sauce.
- **Falafel:** A famous Middle Eastern street food, falafel is a deep-fried patty or ball made from ground chickpeas, fava beans, or lentils. It's typically served in a pita bread with hummus, tahini, chopped vegetables, and amba sauce.
- **Tabbouleh:** This refreshing salad is a staple of Levantine cuisine. It's made with finely chopped parsley, tomatoes, mint, onions, bulgur wheat, and a lemon dressing.
- **Lentil Soup:** Hearty and flavorful, lentil soup is a popular comfort food in Dubai. It's made with lentils, vegetables, and spices.
- **Vegetable Biryani:** This fragrant rice dish is a vegetarian version of the classic Indian biryani. It's made with basmati rice, vegetables, spices, and nuts.
- **Stuffed Grape Leaves:** Also known as yaprak in Turkish cuisine, stuffed grape leaves are a popular appetizer or side dish. They're made with grape leaves stuffed with rice, vegetables, and herbs.
- **Luqaymat-** These homely sweet pastries are shaped into delicate golden balls that melt in the mouth. They're made from flour, sesame seeds, turmeric, milk, sugar, salt, and a little yeast. The batter is kneaded and then left to rest for a while, before being fried in oil and drizzled with syrup.
- **Knafeh-**made of spun pastry, soaked in sweet syrup, layered with melting cheese, and served with clotted cream, pistachio, or other nuts.
- **Khubz or 'Kuboos'** is a classic soft Arabic bread made with all-purpose or wheat flour. Try the freshly made ones at a bakery or restaurant with fresh hummus and an aubergine dip called 'mutabal' as its perfect accompaniment. You can also use the Khubz to wrap all the juicy, delicious ingredients of shawarma, and it can also be paired with any gravy dishes.

Famous Non- Vegetarian Local Dishes

- **Harees:** The ingredients for harees are crushed wheat, minced meat (sometimes chicken), as well as onions, ground cumin, a generous amount of water, and salt. Emirati harees is considered one of the country's best-known traditional dishes.
- **Majboos-** The dish includes basmati rice served with various types of meat. Emirati majboos are frequently served with chicken, with the distinctive flavours of powerful Arabian spices and assorted vegetables
- **Madrouba-** Madrouba with chicken is the best-known variety, though it's also served with fish, lamb, and crushed grains. It's prepared using rice, garlic, onion, tomatoes, yoghurt and seasoning. Butter is also used in moderation.
- **Biryani-** There are several varieties of biryani, including: Iranian, katchi, Sri Lankan, and Southeast Asian. Made with a mix of basmati rice and spices, meat biryani can be served with chicken or other types of meat.
- **Chicken Saloona-** It's prepared with pieces of chicken, turmeric, olive oil, grated ginger, minced garlic, onion, chilli, spices and white rice.
- **Oozie-** This dish is made with rice and can be stuffed into delicate pastry pockets, or it can also be served with chicken. Sometimes, it's also served with salad and yoghurt, or garnished with a mixture of fried or roasted nuts.
- **Jasheed-** It's made from small sharks, or other fish if these aren't available, and eaten with rice. It's served with white 'aysh (rice) and clarified butter
- **Tahta malih** is a traditional dish of Dubai that's still popular today. Its original flavours have been preserved, just like the fish that is used to make it
- **Chebab-** The *chebab* is a traditional Emirati pancake and a favorite breakfast staple in Dubai. This popular food is thickened with yeast, delicately flavored with cardamom, saffron, and turmeric, and typically served with date syrup, cheese, or eggs.
- **Margoogat** is a succulent Arabic stew, typically made with chicken or lamb and flavored with tomato, garam masala, spices, and vegetables, creating a delicious blend of sweet, spicy, and tangy flavors. It is often served with yogurt or cucumber salad.
- **Khuzi-** It's a tenderly cooked lamb dish with a base of spicy rice and a topping of raisins, vegetables, and roasted nuts, flavored with cardamom, cinnamon, saffron, and nutmeg.
- **Regag** is the most well-known Arabic bread. Cooked on a special pan over high heat, it's a wafer-thin bread that is the perfect base for all kinds of foods, from kebabs to eggs to chocolate spread.

What to buy as souvenirs and from where?

Type of souvenir	Category	Where to buy
Dates	Consumable	Popular brands- Bateel Dates, Al Barakah Dates, Date Crown Supermarkets Date Souk at the Grand Souk
Spices (Especially saffron, cumin, turmeric and cinnamon)		Supermarkets or the Deira Spice Souk
Arabic coffee		Supermarkets
Camel Milk Chocolate		Brand – Al Nassma kiosks at Dubai Mall Bhurj Khalifa The Palm Souk Madinat Jumeirah
Dried fruits and nuts		Supermarkets
Sweets (Baklava, Khabees, Maamoul, and Batheeth)	Personal products (perfume/jewellery /garments/accessories)	Alreef Lebanese Bakery , Al Baba Sweets The Hummingbird Bakery, Mall of Emirates .
Oud and Bakhoor (types of incense)		Traditional perfume shops in malls and the souks like Perfume Souk in Deira
Gold jewellery		Gold Souk in Deira

		Joyalukkas outlets
Traditional Arab shoes		Grand Souk
Arabic Attar (concentrated perfumes made from essential oils, musk, amber etc)		Popular brands- Swiss Arabian Perfumes, Rasasi Perfume Traditional perfume shops in malls and the souks like Perfume Souk in Deira
Kaftans		Grand Souk Malls like Dubai Mall Souk Madinat Jumeirah
Carpets	Keepsakes	Souk Madinat Jumeirah Dubai Mall National Iranian Carpets at Jumeirah Beach National Iranian Carpets at Mall of Emirates
Aladdin lamps		Karama Souq
Kava pots and coffee sets		Dubai Coffee Museum Dubai Mall Mall of Emirates
Incense holders		Souks like the Deira Spice Souk Home Décor Stores in malls
Lanterns (made of copper and tin with filigree work)		Dragon Mart Homes R Us

Electronic gadgets	Electronics	Sharaf DG store, Dubai Mall Bur Dubai area's Al-Fahidi Street
Clothes	Fashion	Dubai Outlet Mall Dubai Outlet Village

Shopping Notes

Electronics: The Bur Dubai Market or commonly known as Meena Bazar is one of the best markets to shop electronics. The street is full of stores that are known to sell everything in electronics such as Gaming Consoles, Cameras, smartphones, laptops, etc. All the stores here in Bur Dubai are known to offer the best electronics at a rock bottom price. Some of the well-known stores here are Jumbo Electronics and Sharaf DG.

Sharaf DG in particular will be having sales during the Dubai Shopping Festival (during last years festival they offered upto 40% off)

In case you do not want to make a separate trip to Meena Bazar, you can visit Sharaf DG outlets at Mall of Dubai and Mall of Emirates (as part of your current itinerary)

Gold:

Gold souk and gold souk extension- There are over 300 retailers in the Gold Souk so take your time looking around and shopping for the best possible prices and rates. The rates can vary based on the making charges and the wastage of the design. Don't be afraid to haggle, because that is an absolute must here and the shopkeepers expect it!

Joyalukkas, Damas, Damiani, Malabar Gold and Diamonds, Rossella, Taiba, and Kalyan Jewellers are the main jewellers that are recommended

Bringing Gold from Dubai to India

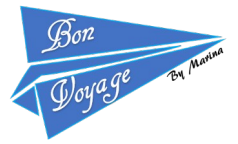
A male traveler can bring 20 grams of gold (up to a maximum value of Rs 50,000) free of customs charge. they can bring gold coins or bars

The duty-free gold limit for female travelers from Dubai is 40 grams, with a maximum value of Rs 1 lakh. When returning from Dubai, women can carry gold in the form of coins, bars, or jewelry

Gold ornaments weighing up to 40 grams are allowed for children under the age of 15 to import without incurring customs duties. This includes gifts or presents in the form of gold. The children, however, must produce identity proof of their relationship to the adults accompanying them

Gold coins are subject to a 10% customs fee if the total weight of the imported coins is less than 100 grams per passenger. 10% custom duty is applied to the total value of the gold coins when their combined weight is between 20 and 100 grams. No customs charge is required if the total weight of the imported gold coin is less than 20 grams.

Passengers traveling from Dubai to India with gold must provide appropriate documents, such as gold purchase invoices and purity and quality certificates. The appropriate inscriptions ought to be on any



gold bars you carry. There ought to include information such as the bar's weight and serial number. Incorrect information provided by passengers may lead to fines and, in certain cases, seizure

Perfumes: Perfume Souk- Ajmal Store, Swiss Arabian- Both offer the finest Arabic and French-inspired fragrances in all their forms, whether as sticks, stones, oils or powders.

Thank You!

Thank you for trusting us with the opportunity to plan your vacation!

We hope your trip is filled with unforgettable memories and special moments together.

Remember, we're always here to assist you—before, during, and even after your journey. Just a call or message away!

Bon Voyage By Marina - 86000-15316